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STUDENT ADMISSION:COM/1003/24

INSTITUTION NAME : UNIVERSITY OF ELDORET

DATE OF SUBMISSION:30/3/2026

RESEARCH TITLE

"Impact of TikTok Engagement on the Socio-Behavioral Activities of Youth: “A Case Study of Eldoret City, Uasin Gishu County, Kenya.”

PROBLEM STATEMENTS

"In Uasin Gishu County, Eldoret City has seen a rapid surge in smartphone penetration and high-speed internet access, making TikTok the most consumed social media platform among the youth. While the platform offers opportunities for digital entrepreneurship and creative expression—aligned with Kenya's 'Digital Masterplan'—there is a visible shift in how youth in Eldoret engage in traditional social and economic activities.

There are rising concerns among parents and community leaders in Eldoret regarding 'digital addiction,' the pursuit of dangerous viral trends, and the erosion of local cultural values. However, most existing research on TikTok is based on Western or Asian contexts, leaving a significant knowledge gap regarding its specific impact on the Kenyan youth's daily productivity and

societal contribution. Without empirical data from a local context like Eldoret, it remains unclear whether TikTok is a tool for youth empowerment or a catalyst for social decay. This study, therefore, seeks to investigate the dual influence of TikTok on youth activities in Eldoret City to determine its net impact on the current society."

DECLARATION

this report proposal is my original work and has not been presented in any institution leading to the award of a degree or any other

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student

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I confirm that the proposal was written by the above named student and has been submitted with our approval as supervisor

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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

Background to the Study In recent years, the landscape of social media has shifted dramatically toward short-form video content, with TikTok emerging as the dominant platform. Youth are the primary consumers and creators on this platform, spending hours daily interacting with its algorithmically curated content. While TikTok offers an unprecedented space for creative expression, global connectivity, and digital learning, it has also sparked significant concern regarding its psychological and behavioral effects on young people. Understanding how this daily interaction shapes the real-world activities of youth is critical to navigating the modern digital age.

Statement of the Problem Despite the widespread use of TikTok among the youth, there is an ongoing debate regarding its actual influence on their offline lives. While some argue that TikTok fosters creativity, digital entrepreneurship, and social awareness (positive influence), others claim it leads to reduced attention spans, participation in dangerous viral trends, and procrastination of productive daily activities (negative influence). Currently, there is a lack of comprehensive research that simultaneously weighs both the positive and negative influences of TikTok on the daily activities of youth and its subsequent impact on society. This study seeks to investigate this duality.

General Objective To investigate the influence of TikTok engagement on the daily activities of youth and to evaluate whether this influence yields predominantly positive or negative societal outcomes.

SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES

- 1. To examine the extent and patterns of youth interaction with the TikTok platform.**
- 2. To determine how TikTok engagement influences the daily behavioral, educational, and social activities of youth.**
- 3. To assess whether the resulting changes in youth activities have a positive or negative impact on current society.**

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

- 1. What are the usage patterns and extent of interaction with TikTok among the youth?**
- 2. In what ways does TikTok influence the daily social, educational, and behavioral activities of young people?**
- 3. Are the societal impacts resulting from TikTok-influenced youth activities predominantly positive or negative?**

Significance of the Study This research will be valuable to parents, educators, and policymakers who are trying to navigate the digital generation. It will provide empirical evidence to help them develop balanced guidelines for social media use. Additionally, it will offer insights to tech companies on how their algorithms impact real-world behavior, promoting safer digital environments.

Scope of the Study The study will focus on youth aged 15 to 24. It will primarily investigate their behavioral changes, academic/work productivity, and social interactions influenced by TikTok. *(in uasin gishu county).*

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

Theoretical Framework is anchored on two main theories:

- **Uses and Gratifications Theory:** This theory explains *why* youth actively seek out TikTok e.g., for entertainment, social interaction, or information and how their specific needs dictate their interaction with the platform.
- **Social Learning Theory:** Proposed by Albert Bandura, this theory posits that people learn behaviors by observing others. This is highly applicable to TikTok, where youth may mimic viral dances, lifestyle habits, or challenges they see on their "For You" page.

Review of Empirical Literature

- **Youth Interaction with TikTok:** Previous studies show that TikTok's highly personalized algorithm creates a highly engaging user experience, often leading to extended screen time compared to other platforms.
- **Positive Influences on Youth Activities:** Literature highlights TikTok as a hub for community building, mental health awareness, and micro-learning (e.g., "BookTok" or educational DIYs). It has empowered youth to engage in social activism and digital entrepreneurship.
 - **Negative Influences on Youth Activities:** Conversely, studies have documented negative outcomes, such as sleep deprivation, cyberbullying, the spread of misinformation, and the prioritization of content creation over academic or physical activities. "Doomscrolling" has also been linked to increased anxiety.

Research Gap While extensive research exists on the mental health impacts of social media in general, studies focusing specifically on TikTok's dual impact

(positive vs. negative) on the *tangible daily activities* of youth remain fragmented.

This study fills the gap by directly evaluating these behavioral changes and assessing their overall societal cost versus benefit.

CHAPTER 3: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Research Design This study will adopt a mixed-methods research design, utilizing both quantitative (surveys) and qualitative (interviews) approaches. This will allow the research to gather broad statistical data on usage patterns while also capturing deep, personal insights into how youth feel the app affects their lives.

Target Population The target population for this study will be youth aged 15 to 24 residing in *in uasin gishu county, eldoret city, Kenya*.

3.3 Sampling Strategy and Sample Size

- **Quantitative:** Stratified random sampling will be used to select participants for the survey to ensure a fair representation of different age brackets and genders. e.g., 150 respondents.
- **Qualitative:** Purposive sampling will be used to select a smaller group e.g., 10-15 active TikTok users, for in-depth interviews.

DATA COLLECTION INSTRUMENTS

- **Questionnaires:** A structured online survey using Google Forms with Likert-scale questions to measure screen time, types of content consumed, and perceived impact on daily productivity.
- **Interview Guide:** A semi-structured guide containing open-ended questions to explore personal experiences, positive outcomes, and negative consequences of TikTok usage.

Data Collection Procedures After obtaining necessary approvals, the digital questionnaire will be distributed via youth networks, student groups, and social media channels. Interviews will be conducted either in-person or via video call, recorded with the participant's permission, and transcribed for analysis.

Data Analysis

- **Quantitative Data:** Survey responses will be analyzed using statistical software (like SPSS or Excel) to generate descriptive statistics (frequencies, percentages) and identify correlations between screen time and daily activities.
- **Qualitative Data:** Interview transcripts will be analyzed using thematic analysis, grouping the responses into core themes (e.g., "Educational Benefits," "Time Management Challenges," "Social Isolation").

Ethical Considerations The research will prioritize ethical standards. Informed consent will be obtained from all participants (and from parents/guardians for those under 18). All data will be kept strictly confidential, and participants will remain entirely anonymous in the final report.

CHAPTER 4: PROJECTED TIME FRAME AND BUDGET

4.1 Work Plan

This study is to be conducted over a period of five months, starting from the proposal approval stage to the final submission of the research report.

Phase	Activity	Duration	Month (2026)
Phase 1	Proposal Defense & Corrections	1Weeks	March
Phase 2	Obtaining Research Permits (UoE)	2 Weeks	April
Phase 3	Data Collection (Fieldwork in Eldoret City)	4 Weeks	May
Phase 4	Data Analysis & Interpretation	3 Weeks	June
Phase 5	Draft Report Writing & Final Submission	3 Weeks	July

RESEARCH BUDGET

The following is an estimate of the financial resources required to successfully execute this research in Uasin Gishu County.

Item Description	Quantity/Unit	Unit Cost (Ksh)	Total Cost (Ksh)
Stationery	Pens, Notebooks, Folders	LS	2,000
Printing & Photocopying	Questionnaires & Drafts	500 pages	3,000
Internet & Airtime	Data for Google Forms/Calls	3 Months	4,500
Travel Expenses	Transport within Eldoret CBD	LS	5,000
Research Assistant	Data entry help (optional)	2 Person	5,000
Binding	Final 3 Hardcover Copies	4 Copies	3,000

Item Description	Quantity/Unit	Unit Cost (Ksh)	Total Cost (Ksh)
TOTAL			22,500

The study expects to find a high correlation between the "For You" page algorithm and the time management habits of youth in Eldoret. It is anticipated that while TikTok serves as a significant platform for creative expression and digital marketing for local "hustles," it also contributes to significant procrastination and a shift away from traditional social face-to-face interactions.

Conclusion

The conclusion will determine if the "net impact" of TikTok on Eldoret's youth is positive (empowerment) or negative (social decay). It will argue whether the platform's influence is a manageable digital evolution or a crisis requiring urgent intervention.

Recommendations

Based on the anticipated findings, the study will recommend:

- 1. For Parents/Guardians: Implementation of "Digital Parenting" and time-restriction features available on the app.**
- 2. For Schools/University of Eldoret: Integration of social media literacy into the curriculum to teach students how to use TikTok for academic and professional branding.**

3. For Uasin Gishu County Government: Creation of digital hubs that encourage youth to pivot from passive consumption to active digital content creation as a form of employment.

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